in Ahmedabad. I am 24 and have been playing international cricket for more than four years and I think, finally, I have learned how to defend properly. Facing Harbhajan Singh's off-spin and Sreesanth's reverse swing, I am feeling secure and solid. Jacques Kallis is batting at the other end, watching and supporting me. His advice has made the difference. Ball by ball, we are working together and guiding our team into a position from where we can win this second Test.

It has been a crazy week. On the evening before the first day, relaxing and chatting with Paul Harris and Mickey Arthur, our coach, in his hotel room, 'Harro' had suddenly piped up and said he thought this will be the match where I score my first double century. It seemed an odd statement to make in front of the coach.

'Why do you say that?' I asked.

'It's just a feeling,' he said.

After the pounding in Chennai, our fast bowlers turn up on the first morning of the Test and sensationally dismiss India for 76 in 20 overs. Dale takes five for 23, Makhaya has three for 18, and Morné claims two for 20. Jubilant team celebrations in the middle follow one after another as India stumble to their second-lowest-ever total at home. We lose early wickets in reply, but Jacques and I take our score to 223 for four at the close.

Now it is the second morning, and Jacques and I are getting ready to resume on 60 and 59 respectively. I happen to see Mickey Arthur in the changing room. The Proteas coach is such a knowledgeable man and such a good man, and, without really thinking, I walk straight up to him and say what's on my mind.

'I feel like I can defend,' I tell him. 'For the first time, I feel like I can defend.'

'Good for you,' he replies.

Jacques and I are back in the middle, aiming to consolidate our position and to build the lead. My batting average in Tests against India is a mediocre 17, but I feel organised and secure.